

XYZ CORPORATION

StreamCut Pro User Guide

User Guide · Version 2.0

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Summary

This guide covers StreamCut Pro 2.0, which extends the 1.0 foundation with an eight-track timeline, a color grading panel with LUT support, an audio ducking tool, and platform-specific export presets for YouTube and Instagram. It supersedes the 1.0 guide for any user who has upgraded, while remaining structurally aligned to it so upgrading readers can jump directly to new sections.

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1. What's New Since Version 1.0

StreamCut Pro 2.0 is a significant capability upgrade from the single-track 1.0 release. The most visible change is the timeline, which now supports up to eight simultaneous video and audio tracks, enabling picture-in-picture, B-roll layering, and multi-language audio.

- Multi-track timeline (up to 8 video + 8 audio tracks), replacing the single-track model.
- Color Grading panel with primary wheels, curves, and third-party LUT import.
- Audio Ducking tool that automatically lowers music under detected dialogue.
- Export Presets for YouTube (1080p/4K), Instagram Reels (9:16), and Instagram Feed (1:1).

2. System Requirements and Installation

2.0 raises the minimum specification versus 1.0 to support real-time color preview: 16 GB RAM and a GPU with at least 4 GB of VRAM are now required. CPUs without GPU acceleration will see reduced color-panel responsiveness.

- Download StreamCut Pro 2.0 from the XYZ Software Portal; 1.0 projects open automatically on first launch.
- Existing 1.0 license keys are honored; no re-purchase is required for this minor-to-major upgrade window.

3. Working with the Multi-Track Timeline

Tracks are stacked vertically, with higher tracks rendering on top of lower tracks for video, and all audio tracks mixed together unless muted or ducked.

1. Click the + icon at the left of the timeline to add a new video or audio track.
2. Drag clips onto any track; overlapping video clips on different tracks composite according to track order and blend mode.
3. Use Track Lock to prevent accidental edits on a finished track while working on others.

4. Color Grading

The Color Grading panel, new in 2.0, is accessed via the Color tab above the preview window. It provides Lift/Gamma/Gain wheels, an RGB curve editor, and support for importing .cube LUT files.

- Select a clip, open the Color tab, and adjust the primary wheels for basic exposure and tint correction.
- Import a .cube LUT via Color > Import LUT to apply a stylistic look across a clip or the whole sequence.
- Use the scopes overlay (waveform and vectorscope) to keep skin tones and exposure within broadcast-safe range.

5. Audio Ducking

Audio Ducking automatically reduces the volume of a music track whenever dialogue is detected on another track, then restores it once dialogue ends.

4. Select the music track and open Audio > Ducking.
5. Choose the dialogue track as the ducking trigger.
6. Set the duck amount (default -12 dB) and release time (default 400 ms).

6. Exporting with Platform Presets

Export in 2.0 adds one-click presets tuned for common distribution platforms, replacing the manual resolution picker from 1.0 for these use cases (the manual picker remains available under Custom).

Preset	Resolution	Aspect Ratio	Typical Use
YouTube 1080p	1920x1080	16:9	Standard YouTube upload
YouTube 4K	3840x2160	16:9	High-resolution YouTube upload
Instagram Reels	1080x1920	9:16	Vertical short-form video
Instagram Feed	1080x1080	1:1	Square feed post

7. Migrating 1.0 Projects

Projects created in 1.0 open in 2.0 on a single video and audio track by default; users must manually redistribute clips onto additional tracks if they want to take advantage of layering. Color grading and ducking are opt-in and do not alter existing 1.0 project appearance until applied.

8. Warnings & Constraints

⚠ Important Notices

- GPU-accelerated color preview requires a supported GPU with at least 4 GB VRAM; on unsupported hardware the Color panel falls back to a slower CPU preview mode.
- LUTs imported from third-party sources are not validated by XYZ Corporation for color accuracy; verify against scopes before client delivery.
- Projects saved in 2.0 that use multi-track features cannot be reopened in StreamCut Pro 1.0.

9. References

- XYZ Software Portal — StreamCut Pro 2.0 download and license migration notes.
- StreamCut Pro 2.0 Release Notes (internal Engineering wiki).
- Color Grading Fundamentals — XYZ Learning Hub course SCP-201.

10. Related Documents

- XYZ_StreamCutPro_UserGuide_v1.0.docx (prior foundational release)
- XYZ_StreamCutPro_UserGuide_v3.0.docx (AI captioning and cloud collaboration update)
- XYZ_StreamCutPro_SOP_VideoRenderingExport_v2.0.docx
- XYZ_StreamCutPro_JobAid_QuickReference_v2.0.docx

11. Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	2024-03-03	M. Alders	Prior foundational release (single-track).
2.0	2024-09-16	M. Alders	Added multi-track timeline, color grading, audio ducking, and platform export presets.